

ACTIVITY 5 — FACILITATOR GUIDE

Brand Perception Audit

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Case Study	25 minutes	LU2	LU2 — Customer Influence

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to assess customer perceptions of the brand, products and services (LU2).

What learners produce

A perception-gap table: Marketing's internal belief vs actual customer feedback, with the top 3 gaps ranked, classified and owned.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- The course slides for the scenario and framework
- Internet access where the activity calls for live research

Set-up

Groups of 3–5. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group. All 17 activities run on the same continuous Nimbus Wellness scenario, so remind learners of where this activity sits in that story before you start.

Scenario / briefing material

The Activity 4 reputation audit surfaced one theme again and again: customers say Nimbus Wellness "doesn't feel personal anymore." Marketing's official position is that nothing has changed — the formulas, ingredients and packaging are exactly what they were a year ago. If the product itself hasn't moved, something else has.

A closer look at Customer Service's own numbers hints at where: average reply time has improved since two outlets added self-checkout kiosks and the contact-centre adopted faster chat macros. The technical quality — what the product does — looks unchanged on paper. But the value quality — how it feels to deal with Nimbus — may have quietly slipped underneath the metrics leadership actually tracks.

Before the founder locks the relaunch brief, your table must compare what Marketing believes against what a sample of real customer feedback actually says, and turn the difference into a short, prioritised gap list leadership can act on this week.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Set up the comparison. Three columns: What Marketing believes What customers actually say The gap. Carry your Activity 4 themes straight into the middle column — this activity builds directly on that evidence rather than starting fresh.	The self-checkout kiosks and chat macros are the planted clue — if no table spots that efficiency gains caused the personalisation loss, surface it in the debrief.
2	State Marketing's position precisely. Write Marketing's claim as they would defend it: formulas, ingredients and packaging are unchanged from a year ago. Note that this is a claim about the PRODUCT, and hold on to that — it is the crux of the whole activity.	Push back on 'improve communication' as an action; require something observable.
3	Separate technical quality from value quality. Define the two before you classify anything. Technical Quality = what the product does, objectively measurable. Value Quality = how it feels to deal with the brand. Marketing's evidence covers only the first.	
4	Classify each gap. Take each gap in your table and tag it Technical or Value. Expect most to land in Value Quality — that is the finding. Where a gap looks technical, ask whether the customer is really describing the product or the experience of buying it.	
5	Interrogate the improving metrics. Customer Service's reply times have IMPROVED, yet perception has worsened. Discuss at your table how that is possible. The answer — faster macros made replies quicker but less personal — is the single most important insight of this activity: a metric can improve while the experience it was meant to measure degrades.	
6	Rank the top three gaps. Order by urgency before the relaunch brief is locked. Rank on impact to the relaunch, not on how easy the gap is to fix.	
7	Define 'closed' and assign an owner. For each of the three, write what closed actually looks like in observable terms, and name the team that owns it. If you cannot describe how you would recognise 'closed', the gap is stated too vaguely — rewrite it.	

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
3 min	Recap the Activity 4 findings and Marketing's official position
7 min	Build the two-column belief-vs-evidence table
6 min	Classify each gap as Technical or Value Quality
6 min	Rank the top 3 gaps and assign an owner
3 min	Define what 'closed' looks like for the most urgent gap

Total: 25 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Looking at the Activity 4 findings alongside what Marketing believes internally, where exactly does customer perception diverge from the company's own view of itself?
2. Is the drift really in Technical Quality (the product itself) or in Value Quality (the experience around it) — and what evidence from the audit supports that?
3. What are the top 3 perception gaps your table would put in front of the founder, and which one is most urgent to close before the relaunch brief is finalised?
4. For each gap, what would "closed" actually look like, and which team would need to own fixing it?

Debrief

Bring the class back together and draw out the learning:

- Ask two or three groups to show what they produced, not just what they concluded.
- Ask what surprised them — the gap between what they assumed and what they found.
- Link the activity explicitly back to LU2 — Customer Influence.
- Remind learners this activity rehearses what the Case Study assessment will require.

Reflection questions:

- Did your table's top gap turn out to be about the product itself, or about how people are treated when they interact with the brand?
- Was there a gap the data supported that still felt uncomfortable to put in front of the founder — and why?
- If Marketing pushed back and insisted the product is the whole story, what evidence would you point to first?

Facilitator notes — what to watch for

- The self-checkout kiosks and chat macros are the planted clue — if no table spots that efficiency gains caused the personalisation loss, surface it in the debrief.
- Push back on 'improve communication' as an action; require something observable.

Success criterion

Every group can show a gap-analysis table comparing Marketing's internal belief against real customer feedback, with the top 3 perception gaps ranked and one concrete action proposed for each.

Assessment link

This activity builds LU2 — Customer Influence. All 17 activities are in-class activities assessed indirectly through the open-book Case Study (CS) component, which reuses the same techniques on the same continuous Nimbus Wellness scenario. Knowledge is assessed in the Written Assessment (WA-SAQ). Nothing is assessed that is not practised here or taught in the slides.

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